



**Key figure:** Abrar Ahmed, the bowler Pakistan will lean on to compensate for an inconsistent pace attack and a fragile middle order. GETTY IMAGES

since it won its second global title in the USA and West Indies. In Jasprit Bumrah and Varun Chakaravathy, India boasts two of the most feared bowlers in the shortest format.

Arshdeep Singh and Hardik Pandya add further depth, both having claimed over 100 international wickets. Both the PowerPlay and the death overs appear well covered.

Depending on conditions, India has the flexibility to bring in the

left-arm wrist-spin variation of Kuldeep Yadav to complement Varun and Axar Patel. This could open up a slot at number eight in the batting order for Harshit Rana. Even if the opponents manage to score heavily, the batting order has the power to keep pace. Abhishek Sharma, arguably India's best batter in the

format since his debut, and Sanju Samson set the tempo from the first over. The decision to drop vice-captain Shubman Gill to give Samson his preferred slot at the top of the order, and the selection of Ishan Kishan over Jitesh Sharma as the second wicketkeeper, show the think tank is veering away from the

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